

Decision-making guide

Customer Relationship Management Microsimulation

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1. Simulation platform introduction

1.1 Game Arena

The gaming arena interface comprises various decision tabs that includes the Market section, Information, Lead management, Communication, Process, Decision Checklist and Reports. Some sections must be completed first as they have an impact on other areas.

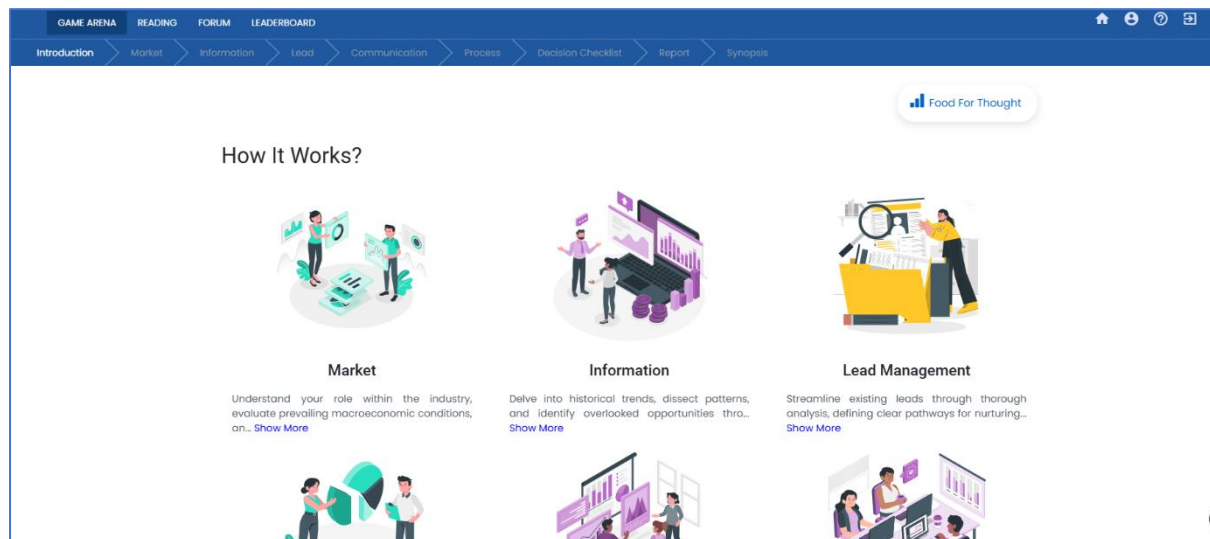


Figure 1 The Game Arena

1.2 Readings

This section provides essential materials necessary for participants to actively engage in the game. The main reading material consists of a guide for decision-making, supplemented by optional additional resources chosen by instructors. Moreover, a walkthrough video is accessible, offering in-depth information about the scenario featured in the simulation. This video presents insights into the industry, ongoing trends, obstacles, and the diverse array of decisions required.

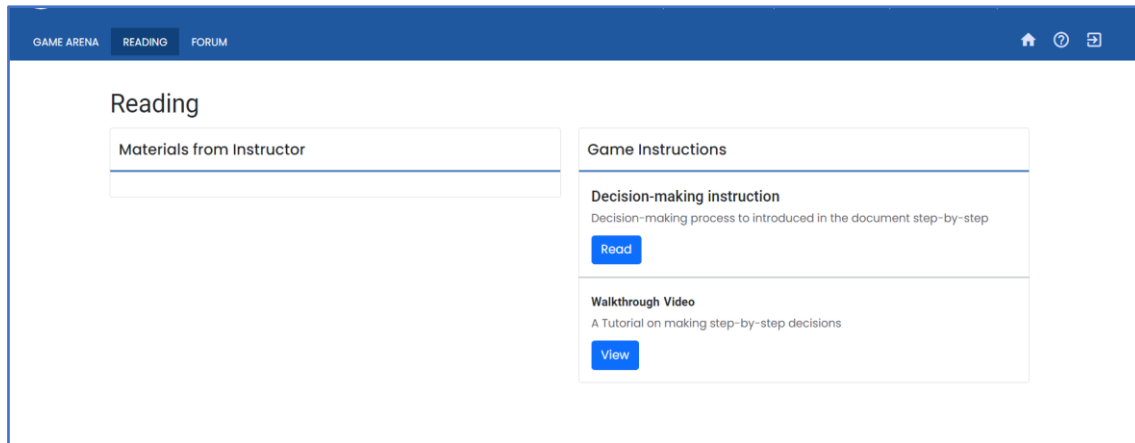


Figure 2 The Readings Section

1.3 Forum

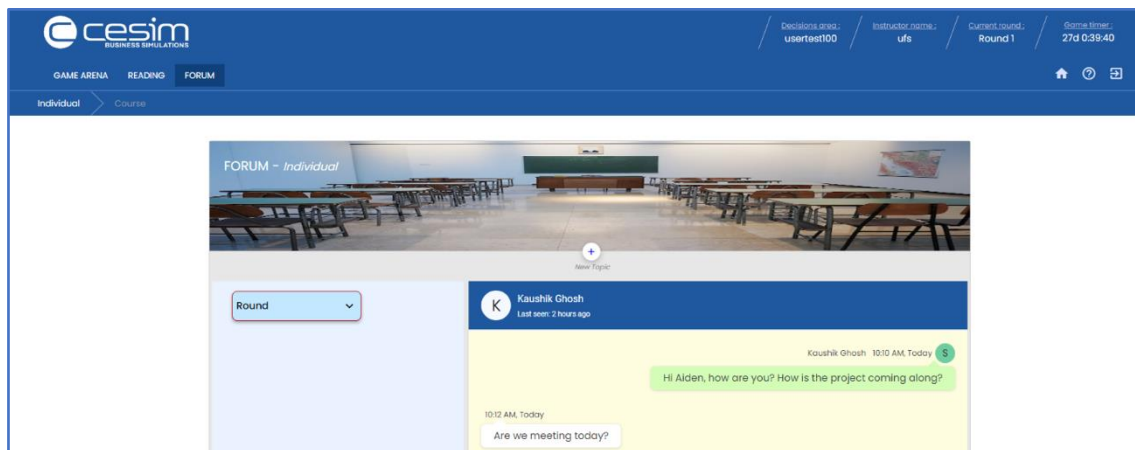


Figure 3 The Forum Section

- The forums provide an excellent platform for participants to engage with their instructors or peers.
- There are two separate forums: the Individual Forum and the Course Forum. The Individual Forum allows participants to communicate directly with the instructor, while the Course Forum is accessible to all enrolled players.
- Instructors can view and respond to posts in both sections. Consequently, the Course Forum is an appropriate space for asking questions that can benefit the entire course, while the Individual Forum is the preferred channel for the individual to have a direct discussion with the professor.
- Participants will receive notifications for messages.

1.4 Main Objective & Winning Criteria

In Bengaluru's thriving tech scene, a pioneering company is transforming industries with its cutting-edge blockchain solutions. The company's software efficiently manages records, streamlines processes, and provides tamper-proof infrastructure for businesses across various sectors. However, despite achieving a 20% year-on-year growth, the company faces challenges in maintaining strong client relationships. Enhancing customer retention, improving follow-up processes, and effectively prioritizing opportunities have become essential to sustaining its growth.

To overcome these challenges, the company seeks the expertise of a seasoned CRM specialist. As the CRM expert, the participant's role is to optimize client management, enhance customer retention, and improve follow-up systems. By doing so, they will help strengthen the company's client relationships and ensure its blockchain solutions continue to empower businesses, driving success in India's dynamic market. The ultimate goal is to enhance customer lifetime value and achieve a minimum value creation of ₹1 lakh or above.

1.5 Successful decision-making flow

The sequence of decision-making unfolds as follows:

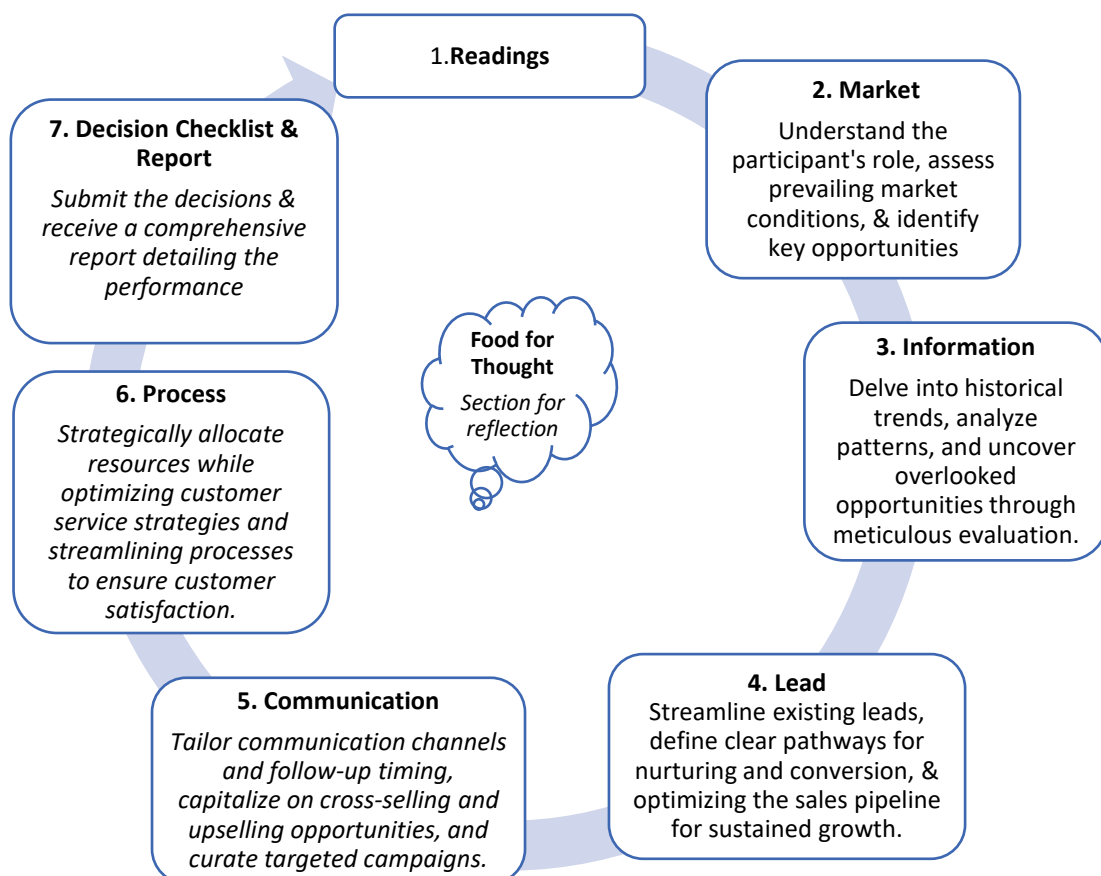


Figure 4 The Sequence of Decision-Making Process

2. Game Arena

2.1 Introduction

This page encompasses information detailing the functioning of the simulation and provides insights into each tab's decision-making.

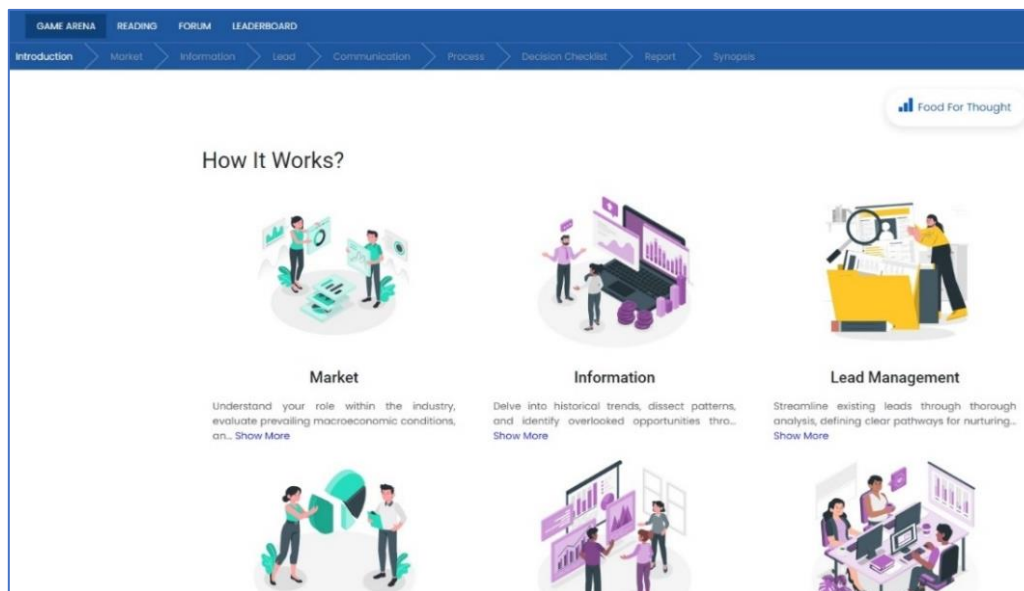


Figure 5 The Introduction Tab

2.2 Food for Thought

The "Food for Thought" section contains questions related to key decision areas, providing valuable insights to guide decision-making. Participants are encouraged to review it before addressing the decision areas, as it offers essential clarity on the decision-making process. Completion of this section is mandatory for round one.

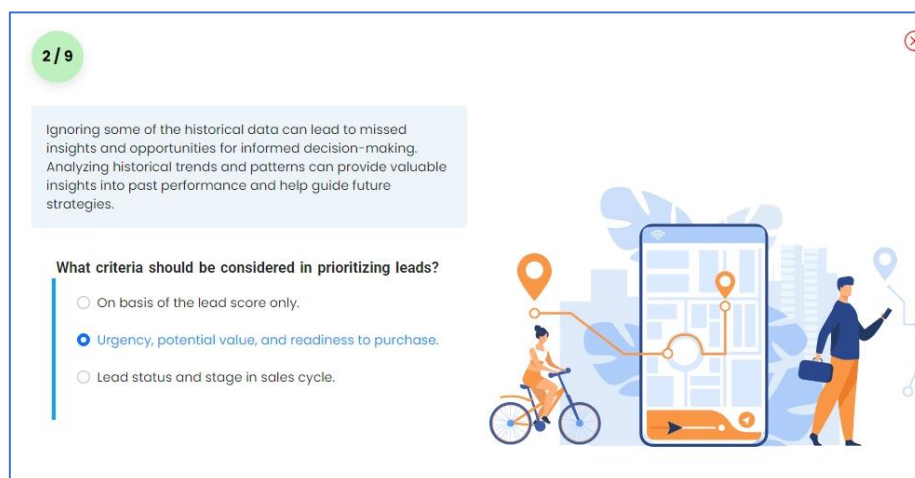


Figure 6 The food for thought section in the Game Arena

2.3 Market

The Market section provides details on the case scenario, an industry overview, and the participant's role within the simulation.



Figure 7 The Market tab in the Game Arena

2.4 Information

The Information section defines key terminology related to lead and pipeline management. It provides insights into the communication strategy, customer service, cross-selling and upselling opportunities, resource and value contribution, as well as revenue streams over the past three years.

Some important Terms in the Information Section Includes:

- a. **Average Lead Response Time:** The average time it takes for the company to respond to new leads. Faster response times often lead to higher conversion rates.
- b. **Customer Service Response Rate:** This measures how quickly the customer service team responds to inquiries or complaints. A high response rate indicates the team is efficient in addressing customer issues.

- c. **Average Resolution Time:** This is the average time it takes for customer service to resolve a customer's issue, measured over three years. A shorter resolution time generally contributes to higher customer satisfaction.
- d. **Cross-Selling:** Encouraging customers to purchase related or complementary products. For example, if a customer buys a laptop, offering them a laptop bag.
- e. **Upselling:** Persuading customers to purchase a more expensive or upgraded version of a product or service. For instance, offering an upgraded version of a software package with more features.
- f. **Customer Acquisition Costs (CAC):** This refers to the total cost incurred by a company to acquire a new customer. It includes expenses related to marketing, sales efforts, and any other activities involved in attracting and converting leads into paying customers. Lower CAC is desirable as it means the company is acquiring customers more efficiently.
- g. **Average Purchase Order Value:** This represents the average monetary value of each order or purchase made by a customer over a certain period. It reflects how much revenue, on average, each customer generates per order. A higher average purchase order value indicates that customers are making larger purchases, contributing more to the company's revenue.
- h. **Average Frequency Per Year:**
This term refers to the average number of times a customer makes a purchase or interacts with a company within a year.
- i. **Life Span Years:**
Life span years refer to the average duration a customer remains active or engaged with a company before they stop purchasing or become inactive.
- j. **Churn Rate Percentage:**
The churn rate percentage represents the proportion of customers who stop doing business with a company during a specific period, typically expressed as a percentage of the total customer base.

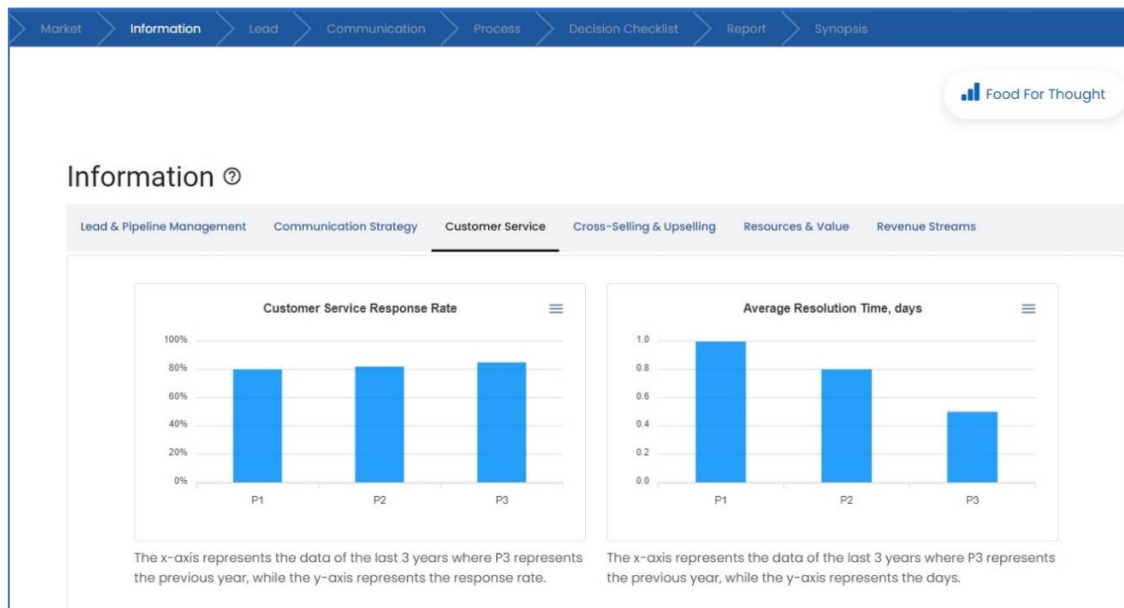


Figure 8 The Information Tab in the Game Arena

2.5 Lead

Under the Lead tab, participants are tasked with managing their client pipeline. They can categorize clients into high, medium, or low priority based on several factors. Information such as lead source, their Industry, Budget, level of urgency, lead score, current status, and the stage of the lead is provided, along with suggested follow-up actions. Based on this data, participants must decide the criteria at which they plan so that to effectively manage their clients.

Pipeline Management

High
Indicates a pressing requirement for attention and follow-up to capitalize on potential opportunities.

Low
Indicating that follow-up and engagement can be deferred or approached more casually.

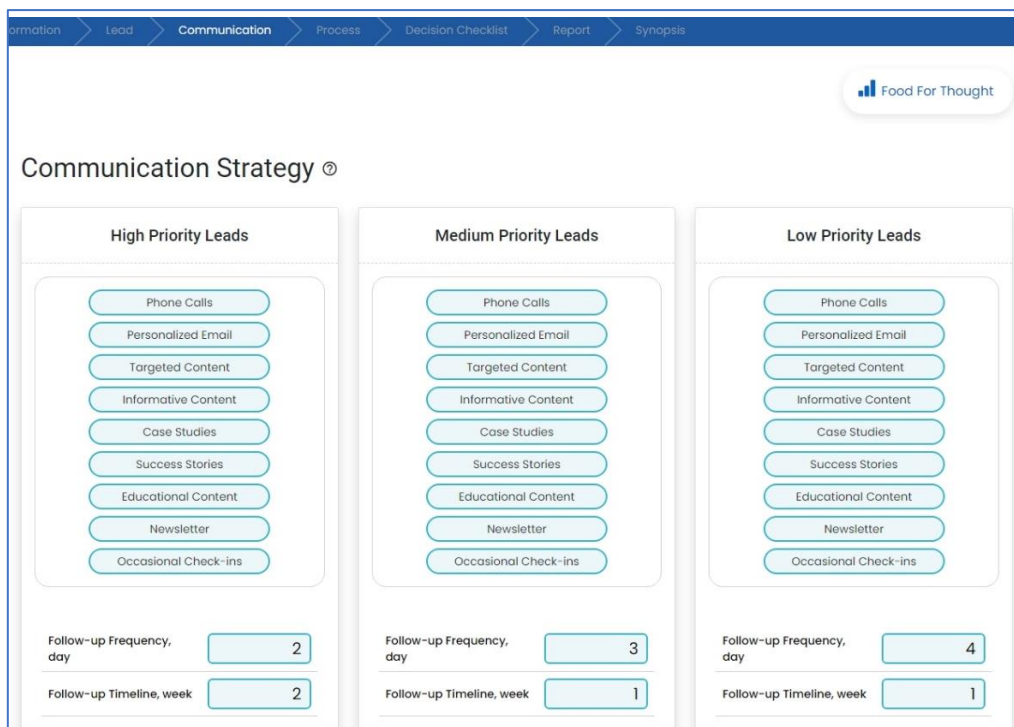
Medium
Requiring attention and follow-up but not as immediate as high-priority leads.

Lead ID	Contact Information	Lead Source	Industry	Budget	Urgency	Lead Score	Lead Status	Stage in Sales Cycle	Next Steps	Follow-up Actions	Priority
1	Rahul Gupta	Online Form	Healthcare	High	Immediate Need	85	Contacted	Interest	Schedule Demo	Email Follow-up	Medium
2	Priya Sharma	Email Inquiry	Technology	Medium	Urgent	70	Follow-up Scheduled	Decision	Proposal Preparation	Phone Call	Medium
3	Ravi Singh	Trade Show Visit	Retail	Low	Future Potential	60	New Lead	Awareness	Follow-up Call	Email Follow-up	Medium
4	Neha Patel	Referral	Healthcare	Medium	Immediate Need	80	Proposal Sent	Decision	Negotiation	Phone Call	High
5	Shikha Jain	Online Form	Retail	High	Urgent	75	Contacted	Interest	Schedule Demo	Email Follow-up	Medium

Figure 9 The Lead Tab in the Game Arena

2.6 Communication

Under the Communication tab, participants are responsible for shaping the communication strategy to effectively reach clients. They must determine the optimal combination of communication methods for managing high, medium, and low-priority leads. Additionally, participants will decide the follow-up frequency per day and set a follow-up timeline per week. In this section, participants are also responsible for identifying the ideal moments to initiate cross-selling and upselling opportunities with clients. They must also select strategies tailored to nurturing leads across different categories through targeted marketing campaigns, with the goal of enhancing engagement and driving conversions.



High Priority Leads	Medium Priority Leads	Low Priority Leads
Phone Calls	Phone Calls	Phone Calls
Personalized Email	Personalized Email	Personalized Email
Targeted Content	Targeted Content	Targeted Content
Informative Content	Informative Content	Informative Content
Case Studies	Case Studies	Case Studies
Success Stories	Success Stories	Success Stories
Educational Content	Educational Content	Educational Content
Newsletter	Newsletter	Newsletter
Occasional Check-ins	Occasional Check-ins	Occasional Check-ins
Follow-up Frequency, day: 2	Follow-up Frequency, day: 3	Follow-up Frequency, day: 4
Follow-up Timeline, week: 2	Follow-up Timeline, week: 1	Follow-up Timeline, week: 1

Figure 10 Communication Tab in the Game Arena

2.7 Process

Under the Process tab, participants are tasked with identifying ways to enhance customer service. They can select effective service enhancement options, allocate hours for customer service and lead management, and make decisions on process streamlining to improve operational efficiency. When choosing improvements, participants must consider the associated costs, the objectives of each option, and how these choices align with the company's overall goals.

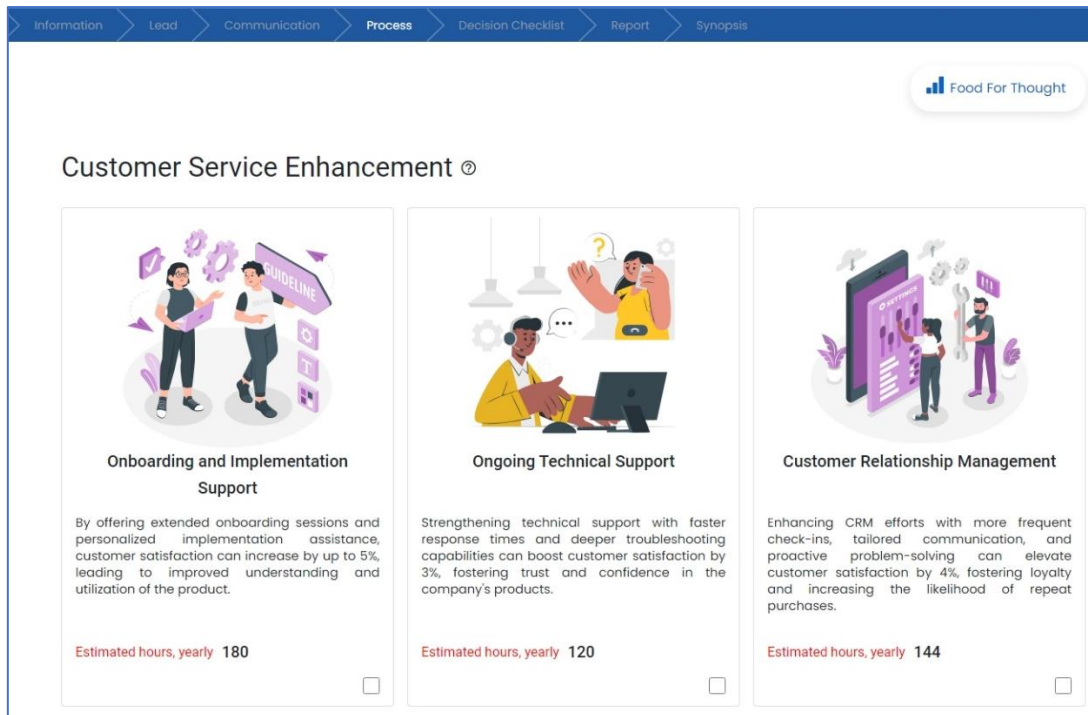


Figure 11 The Process tab in the Game Arena

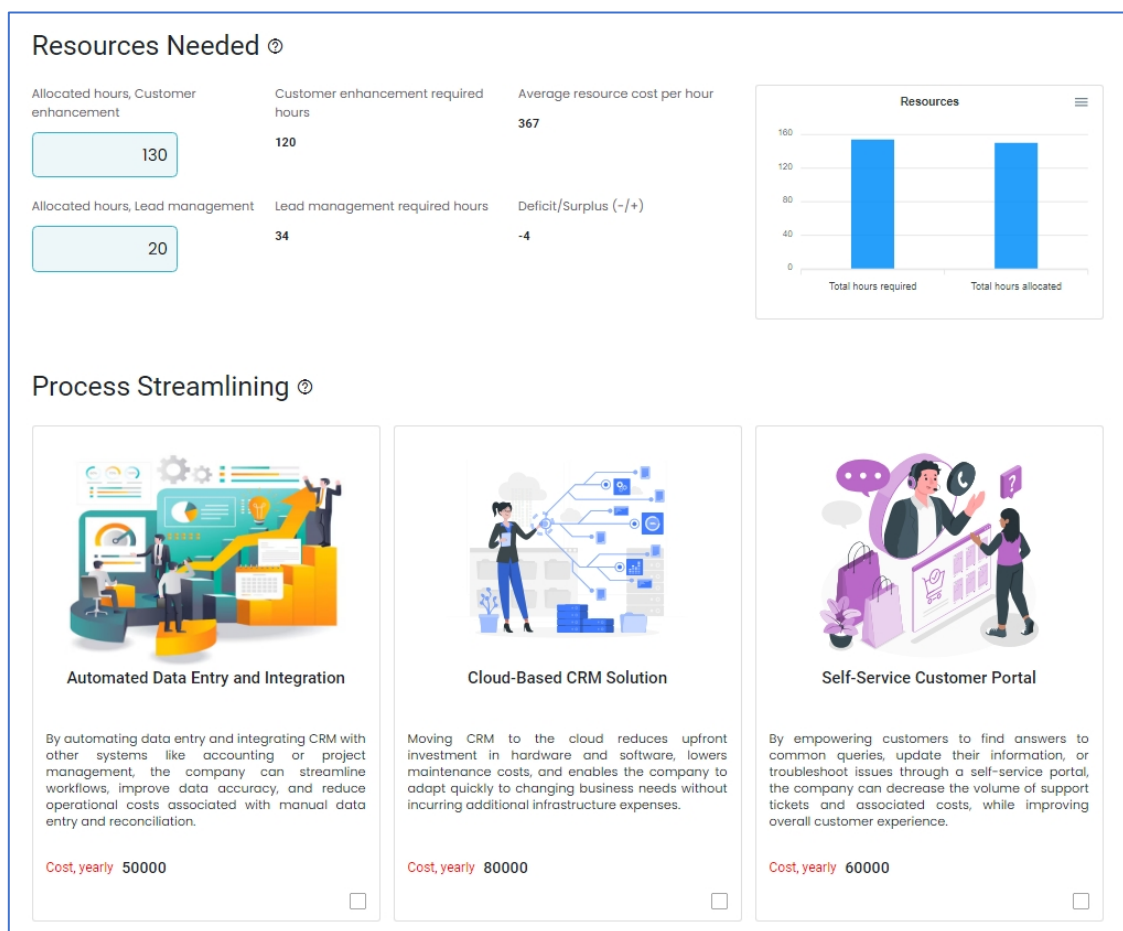


Figure 12 The Process tab in the Game Arena

2.8 The Decision Checklist

The Decision Checklist helps participants review and adjust their decisions before the deadline. Once decisions are confirmed, they can submit them using the "Submit" option and choose **save and proceed**. It's important to remember that once decisions are submitted and saved, they cannot be changed for that round. This ensures that decisions are carefully considered before finalization, promoting clarity and accountability in the decision-making process.

Decision Checklist

Round 1
 ▼

User

Lead Management	
Lead 1	High
Lead 2	Medium
Lead 3	High
Lead 4	Medium
Lead 5	High
Lead 6	Medium
Lead 7	High
Lead 8	Medium
Lead 9	High
Lead 10	Medium
Lead 11	Medium
Lead 12	Medium
Lead 13	Medium
Lead 14	Medium
Lead 15	Medium
Lead 16	High
Lead 17	Low
Lead 18	High
Lead 19	Medium
Lead 20	High
Lead 21	Medium

Figure 13 The Decision Checklist in the Game Arena

2.9 Report

The report section provides the details on the participants' critical thinking abilities. It demonstrates how their thought process influenced the outcomes, providing insights into the impact of their decision-making skills.

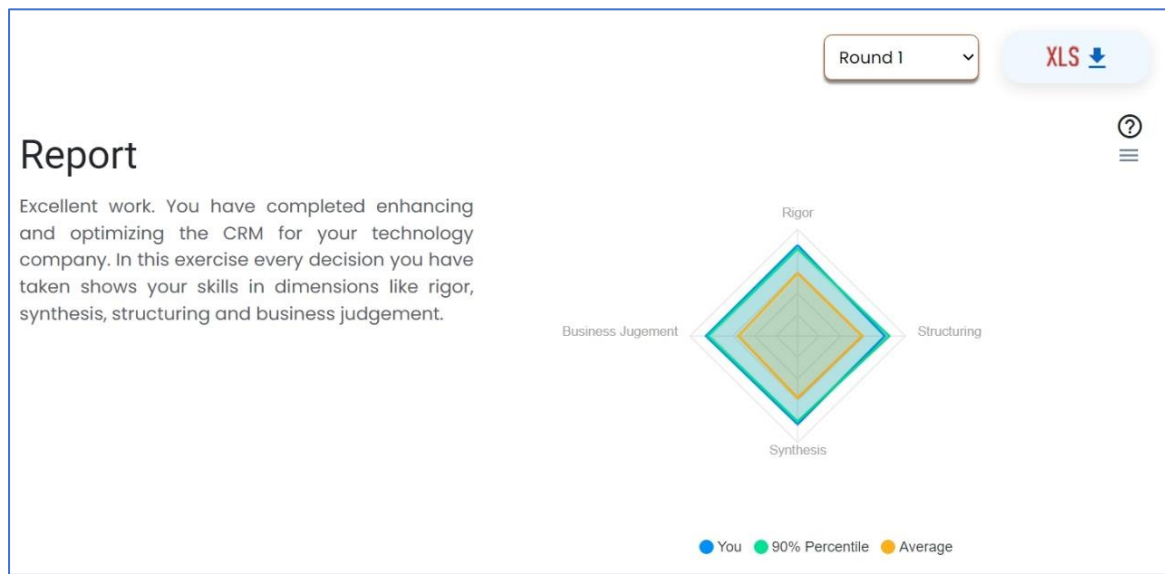


Figure 14 The Report Section in the Game Arena

This section consists of feedback on the performance of the participant based on four metrics.

- **Rigour:** Consistency throughout the decision-making and recommendation.
- **Structuring:** Logical approach of gathering and analysing information
- **Synthesis:** Approach towards interpreting information and making informed decisions
- **Business Judgement:** Ability to evaluate facts, and consider risks and possible implications when making decision.

The Report consists of various sections such as :

1. **Lead Pipeline Count** that provides details on the number of leads the participant has categorized as high, medium, or low priority. It also includes the sales conversion probabilities based on the participant's pipeline management decisions.
2. **The Resource Allocation section** displays the participants' decisions on the hours allocated for pipeline management. It also indicates any surplus or deficit, reflecting how accurately they were able to forecast resource requirements.

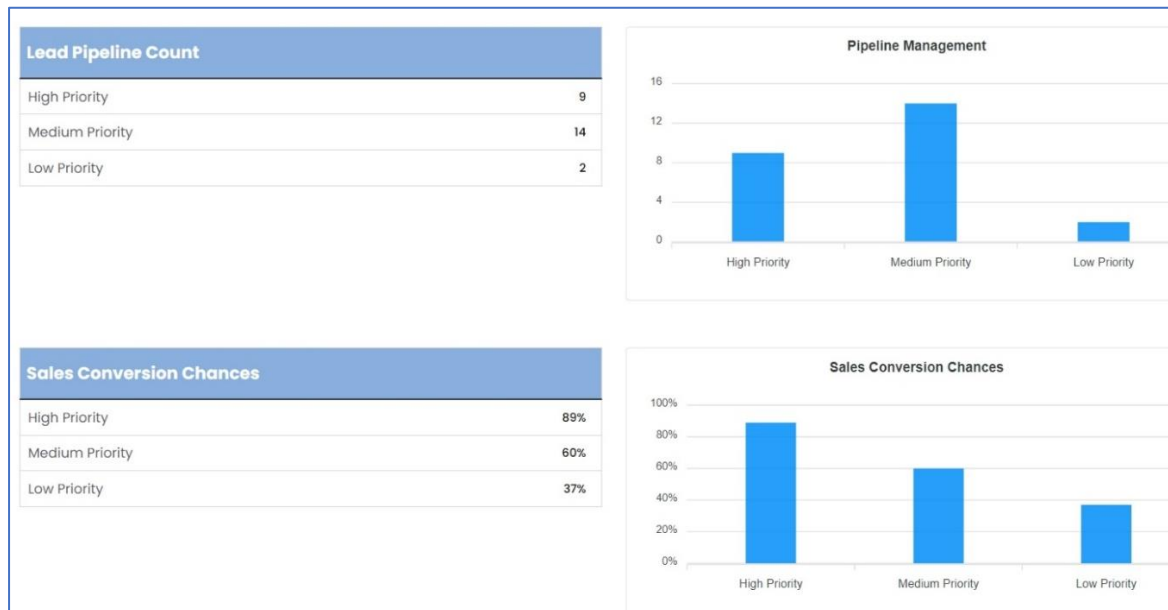


Figure 15 The Report Section in the Game Arena

3. **The Value Creation Section :** The goal of the simulation is to enhance value creation compared to the previous year. The Value Creation section displays the previous Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) and the expected New CLV based on participant decisions. The difference is shown as either an increase or decrease in CLV, along with the probability of achieving this change. After accounting for all incurred costs, participants can view the overall value created for the round.
4. **The KPI Variation section:** Highlights changes in key metrics such as cross-selling and upselling opportunities, customer service response rate, average resolution time, and pipeline velocity days.
5. **Cross-Selling and Upselling Opportunities :** This refers to the percentage increase/decrease in opportunities to either cross-sell (sell related products or services) or upsell (encourage customers to purchase a more expensive version or add-ons) to existing clients.

6. **Customer Service Response Rate** : This is the improvement in how quickly the customer service team responds to client inquiries.

7. **Average Resolution Time** : This metric tracks the time it takes to resolve customer issues or inquiries. A better percentage means that the problems are being resolved faster, which enhances the customer experience by minimizing the time they spend waiting for a solution.

8. **Pipeline Velocity Days** : Pipeline velocity refers to the speed at which leads move through the sales pipeline. A less percentage / number means the leads are advancing through the sales process more quickly, potentially leading to faster conversions and a shorter sales cycle.

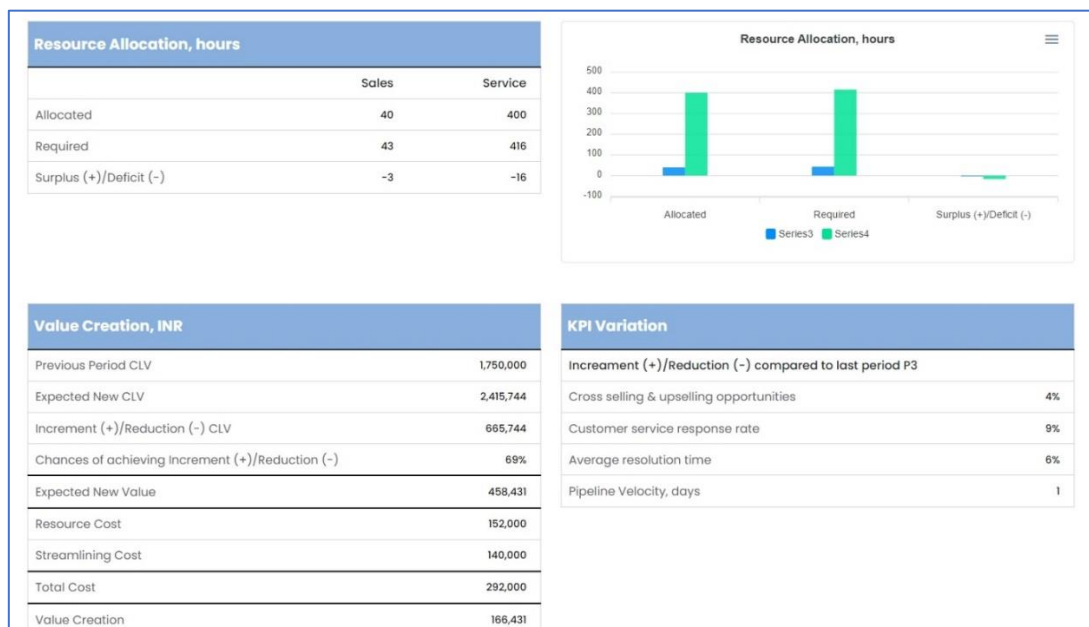


Figure 16 The Report section showing the KPI of the Simulation

2.10 Synopsis

The synopsis section provides a condensed overview of the key decision areas and outcomes. It offers participants a quick reference point to grasp the essence of their decisions and their thinking ability, aiding in holistic understanding and future planning.

Synopsis		Round 1	XLS
Decisions		Value Creation, INR	
Parameters	Input	Parameter	Output
Lead 1	High	Previous Period CLV	1,750,000
Lead 2	Medium	Expected New CLV	2,415,744
Lead 3	High	Increment (+)/Reduction (-) CLV	665,744
Lead 4	Medium	Chances of achieving Increment (+)/Reduction (-)	69%
Lead 5	High	Expected New Value	458,431
Lead 6	Medium	Resource Cost	152,000
Lead 7	High	Streamlining Cost	140,000
Lead 8	Medium	Total Cost	292,000
Lead 9	High	Value Creation	166,431
Lead 10	Medium		
Lead 11	Medium		
Lead 12	Medium		
Lead 13	Medium		
Lead 14	Medium		
Lead 15	Medium		
Lead 16	High		
Lead 17	Low		
Lead 18	High		
Lead 19	Medium		
Lead 20	High		
Lead 21	Medium		
Lead 22	High		
Lead 23	Medium		
Lead 24	Low		
		KPI Variation	
		Increment (+)/Reduction (-) compared to last period P3	
		Cross selling & upselling opportunities	4%
		Customer service response rate	9%
		Average resolution time	6%
		Pipeline Velocity, days	1
		Lead Pipeline Count	
Parameters		Parameters	Output
		High Priority	9
		Medium Priority	14
		Low Priority	2
		Round 2	

Figure 17 The Synopsis Section in the Game Arena

To proceed to the next iteration, follow these steps:

1. Navigate to the end of the synopsis page to locate the link for the next round.
2. Click on the 'Round' to advance to the next round.
3. You will be redirected to the home page.
4. Click on the card to begin the next round.